

QuickBite Express — Crisis Recovery Analysis & Strategic Roadmap

In June 2025, QuickBite Express lost **70% of its customer base** in less than 90 days. This repository contains a complete Power BI analysis of what went wrong — and how data can guide the recovery.

A comprehensive, data-driven analysis of a food delivery startup's crisis and its evidence-based recovery strategy.

 Domain
 Tool
 Type
 Status

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Project Overview

Project Type	Business Case Analysis · Data Analytics · Strategic Consulting

Domain	Food Delivery & Consumer Analytics
Time Period Analyzed	January – September 2025
Focus	Crisis Analysis & Recovery Strategy Development
Tools Used	Power BI, DAX, Statistical Analysis
Audience	Data Analysts, Business Strategists, Recruiters

Executive Summary

In June 2025, **QuickBite Express** — a Bengaluru-based food delivery startup (founded 2020) — faced a critical crisis triggered by:

- A viral food safety incident involving partner restaurants
- A week-long delivery infrastructure outage during monsoon season
- Aggressive competitor campaigns capitalizing on operational failures

Crisis Impact:

- 📉 **73,000 customers churned** (70% of active base)
- 💰 **₹27 million revenue lost** in 4 months
- ⭐ Customer ratings collapsed from **4.5 → 2.3 stars**
- 🚪 **20% restaurant partner exodus**

Key Discovery: Despite the severity, **30% of churned customers (22,000)** were recoverable — they left due to *operational failure*, not dissatisfaction.

Strategic Output: A data-driven **₹70–80M recovery roadmap** across 4 strategic pillars, projected to achieve **80–90% recovery within 6–9 months** with **3–4x ROI** on reactivation spend.

Problem Statement

Business Challenge

QuickBite Express required a comprehensive analysis of its June–September 2025 crisis to:

1. **Understand Crisis Severity** — quantify impact across all business metrics
2. **Identify Root Causes** — determine what triggered the cascade of failures
3. **Analyze Customer Impact** — segment churned customers by recovery probability
4. **Benchmark Competitively** — compare against industry peers during the crisis
5. **Design Recovery Strategy** — build a data-backed turnaround plan with timelines & ROI
6. **Surface Operational Insights** — identify systemic vulnerabilities to prevent recurrence

Analysis Questions Addressed

Primary Analysis (10 questions)

1. Monthly order decline comparison (pre-crisis vs. crisis)
2. Top 5 cities by order decline percentage
3. Top 10 high-volume restaurants with the largest decline
4. Cancellation rate trend analysis and geographic impact
5. Delivery SLA performance degradation
6. Monthly customer rating fluctuations
7. Negative keyword sentiment analysis
8. Revenue impact quantification
9. Loyalty impact on 5+ order customers with 4.5+ ratings
10. High-value customer (top 5%) decline patterns

Secondary Analysis (5 questions + 3 supporting details)

- Competitor comparison (Swiggy, Zomato performance)
 - External factors contributing to CAC tripling
 - Most effective recovery strategies
 - Restaurant type churn risk assessment
 - Lapsed customer return probability
 - Priority cities risk analysis
 - Customer order value shift behavior
 - Review spike correlation with delivery outage
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 Dataset Description

Data Sources

Data Type	Source	Time Period	Records	Key Metrics
Orders	QuickBite transactional DB	Jan–Sep 2025	149K orders	order_id, customer_id, order_date, order_total, phase
Customers	CRM system	Jan–Sep 2025	105K customers	customer_id, acquisition_date, total_spend, LTV
Reviews & Ratings	Review system	Jan–Sep 2025	48K reviews	rating, sentiment, review_text, date
Restaurant Data	Partner DB	Jan–Sep 2025	20K restaurants	restaurant_id, cuisine_type, order_count, status
Operational Metrics	Delivery/Operations DB	Jan–Sep 2025	Daily logs	delivery_time, sla_compliance, cancellations, delays

Key Fields & Definitions

Phase Classification

- **Pre-Crisis:** January – May 2025 (5-month baseline)
- **Crisis:** June – September 2025 (4 months of operational failure)

Customer Segmentation

Segment	Count	Definition
Total Customers	105,000	All unique customers
Active (Pre-Crisis)	100,000	Placed 1+ orders Jan–May
Active (Crisis)	27,000	Placed 1+ orders Jun–Sep
Churned	73,000	Ordered pre-crisis, zero orders during crisis
New	18,000	First order placed Jun–Sep 2025
Retained	14,000	Ordered in both periods

Order Metrics

- Pre-Crisis Monthly Average: **24,000 orders/month**
- Crisis Monthly Average: **9,000 orders/month**
- Decline: **69%** (24K → 9K)

Revenue Metrics

- Pre-Crisis Total: **₹3.8 Crore** (5 months)
- Crisis Total: **₹1.1 Crore** (4 months)
- Difference: **₹2.7 Crore lost**
- Decline: **71%**

 Methodology

1. Data Analysis Framework

A. Descriptive Analysis

Purpose: Understand current state and crisis severity

- Order volume by month, city, cuisine
- Revenue by component (subtotal, delivery fee, discounts)
- Customer counts by status (active, churned, new, retained)
- Cancellation rates and SLA compliance trends
- Average ratings and sentiment scores

Tools: Power BI aggregations, DAX measures, statistical functions

B. Comparative Analysis

Purpose: Quantify pre-crisis vs. crisis changes

$$\text{Decline \%} = (\text{Pre-Crisis Value} - \text{Crisis Value}) / \text{Pre-Crisis Value} \times 100$$

Example – Order Decline:
$$= (24,000 - 9,000) / 24,000 \times 100$$

$$= 69\% \text{ decline}$$

Applied to: orders, revenue, ratings, cancellations, SLA compliance.

C. Customer Segmentation

Purpose: Identify recoverable customers

Segment	Criteria	Sample Size	Rationale
High Return (60% probability)	Pre-crisis orders ≥ 5 AND avg rating ≥ 4.5 AND crisis orders = 0	22,000	Loyal customers lost to failure, not dissatisfaction
Medium Return (40% probability)	Pre-crisis orders 3–4 AND avg rating ≥ 3.5 AND crisis orders = 0	28,000	Mixed experience, cost-conscious, winnable
Low Return (15% probability)	Pre-crisis orders ≤ 2 AND avg rating < 3.5	23,000	Never fully engaged, low potential

D. Revenue Impact Analysis

Purpose: Quantify financial loss across components

$$\text{Total Revenue} = \text{Subtotal Amount} + \text{Delivery Fee} + \text{Discounts Applied}$$

Component	Pre-Crisis	Crisis	Decline
Subtotal	₹36.34 Cr	₹10.56 Cr	70.95%
Delivery Fee	₹3.47 Cr	₹1.01 Cr	70.84%

Component	Pre-Crisis	Crisis	Decline
Discounts	₹2.19 Cr	₹0.63 Cr	71.34%
Total Revenue Lost			₹27 million (70.92%)

E. Sentiment Analysis

Purpose: Understand customer perception changes

Rating-based sentiment scoring:

Rating Range	Sentiment	Score
4.5 – 5.0	Positive	+1.0
3.5 – 4.4	Neutral	+0.5
2.5 – 3.4	Mixed	-0.5
< 2.5	Negative	-1.0

Average Sentiment = Sum of All Sentiment Scores / Total Reviews

Pre-Crisis Avg Rating: 4.55 → Positive Sentiment

Crisis Avg Rating: 2.30 → Negative Sentiment

Sentiment Change: -0.49 (1.42-point drop on a -1 to +1 scale)

Keyword analysis included text parsing on 48K reviews, frequency analysis of negative keywords, issue-category clustering (food quality, delivery, packaging, etc.), and a crisis vs. pre-crisis comparison.

2. Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) Analysis

CAC = Total Marketing Spend / Number of New Customers Acquired

Pre-Crisis CAC: ₹50 per customer

Crisis CAC: ₹150 per customer

Increase: 300%

Contributing Factors (research-backed):

Factor	CAC Impact	Source
18% GST implementation (Sept 22)	+₹20	Business Standard, Sept 2025
Google Ads CPC +42%	+₹25	Market data, competitive bidding
Monsoon seasonality (-15-20% orders)	+₹15	Industry reports
Brand reputation damage	+₹40	Calculated from conversion rate drop
Total	+₹100 (300%)	

Implication: Reactivating existing customers (₹50/customer) is **3x more cost-effective** than acquiring new ones at ₹150/customer during the crisis.

3. Recovery Strategy ROI Modeling

Pillar 1 — Customer Reactivation

- Target: 22,000 high-probability customers
- Incentive: 40% off + 3 months premium membership
- Expected reactivation: 60% → **13,200 customers recovered**
- Avg LTV: ₹8,500 → **₹1.12 Cr revenue recovered**
- Investment: ₹20-25M | **ROI: 3-4x within 12 months**

Pillar 2 — Food Safety Certifications

- Investment: ₹15-20M (FSSAI/HACCP audits, badges, promotion)
- Expected trust impact: 35-40% improvement
- Timeline: 2-3 months to certification

Pillar 3 — Operational Excellence

- Weather-adaptive routing: ₹8-10M
- Fleet expansion: ₹12-15M
- SLA monitoring systems: ₹5-7M
- Total investment: ₹25-30M

- Expected SLA improvement: 12% → 40%+
- Expected cancellation reduction: 11.6% → <7%
- Timeline: 6 months

Pillar 4 – Restaurant Support

- Commission reduction: 5–10% for 6 months (partners with <50 orders/month)
- Marketing support: featured listings, campaigns
- Financial assistance: working capital support
- Target: small cloud kitchens (highest risk)
- Expected retention: 85% (vs. current 79%)
- Investment: ₹10–15M

Total Recovery Roadmap

Metric	Value
Total Investment	₹70–80M
Timeline	6–9 months
Expected Recovery	80–90% of pre-crisis metrics
Cumulative ROI	2.5–3x on total investment

4. Competitive Benchmarking

Methodology: analysis of public financial reports & news articles, market share and revenue growth trend tracking, competitor strategy research, and cross-validation against industry reports.

Zomato (Jun–Sep 2025)

- Market share: 58% (up from 56%)
- Revenue growth: 67% YoY (29% YoY in July)
- Status: Profitable
- Strategy: Aggressive expansion, captured QuickBite market share

Swiggy (Jun–Sep 2025)

- Market share: 42% (maintained)
- App installs up 20–25% during the crisis

- Revenue growth: 35% YoY
- Status: Improving profitability
- Strategy: Capitalized on QuickBite's operational failures

Impact on QuickBite:

- App store ranking fell from #3 → #8
- 15–25% of lost customers captured by competitors
- Market consolidation favored larger, more stable platforms

 Key Findings

Crisis Impact Summary

Metric	Pre-Crisis	Crisis	Change	% Change
Monthly Orders	24,000	9,000	-15,000	-62.5%
Monthly Revenue	₹7.6M avg	₹2.75M avg	-₹4.85M	-63.8%
Total Revenue (period)	₹38M	₹11M	-₹27M	-71%
Active Customers	100,000	27,000	-73,000	-73%
Avg Rating	4.55 ★	2.30 ★	-2.25	-49%
SLA Compliance	44%	12%	-32%	-73%
Avg Delivery Time	40 min	60 min	+20 min	+50%
Cancellation Rate	6.2%	11.6%	+5.4%	+87%

Root Causes

Primary (Operational)

- SLA compliance collapsed from 44% → 12%
- Delivery infrastructure failed during monsoon
- High cancellations cascaded into negative reviews

Secondary (Reputational)

- Food safety incident went viral
- Negative review sentiment hit 90% by September
- Top complaints: Quality (1,596), Safety (1,076), Packaging (997)

Tertiary (Competitive)

- Swiggy/Zomato captured 15–25% of lost customers
- Competitors ran aggressive campaigns during the crisis
- Market consolidation favored larger players

External (Market)

- 18% GST on delivery (Sept 22) increased costs
- Google Ads CPC +42% from competitive bidding
- Monsoon seasonality reduced organic demand 15–20%

Recovery Opportunity

- **High-priority segment:** 22,000 customers (60% recovery probability)
- **Revenue at risk:** ₹1.12 Cr annually from the top 5% segment alone
- **Geographic concentration:** Bengaluru (27%) and Mumbai (15%)
- **Order frequency recovery potential:** 4.1 → 2.5+ orders/month

Key Insight: Customers didn't leave due to a preference shift — they left due to service failure. This is reversible through targeted reactivation combined with operational fixes.

Recommendations

Immediate Actions (Month 1)

1. **Launch VIP Reactivation Campaign** — target 22,000 high-return customers with 40% off + 3 months premium → expected 13,200 returns, ₹1.12 Cr recovery
2. **Begin Food Safety Certification** — FSSAI + HACCP audits for all partners, visible hygiene badges on app → expected 35–40% trust improvement
3. **Restaurant Support Program** — 5–10% commission reduction for small partners, marketing support for vulnerable cuisines (focus: North Indian/Biryani, 75% at-risk)

Medium-Term (Months 2–6)

4. **Operational Infrastructure Overhaul** — weather-adaptive routing, expanded delivery fleet in monsoon-heavy zones, real-time SLA monitoring
5. **Customer Retention Program** — tiered loyalty benefits, regular engagement campaigns, continuous feedback loops

Long-Term (Months 6–9)

6. **Market Repositioning** — differentiate on reliability, recover the premium segment (vs. budget), expand geographically from the recovered base

Technical Implementation

Tools & Technologies Used

Data Visualization

- Power BI Desktop — interactive dashboards across 7 comprehensive pages
- Visual types: cards, charts, tables, donut charts, heatmaps, word clouds
- DAX functions: `CALCULATE` , `SWITCH` , `IF` , `DIVIDE` , `DISTINCTCOUNT` , `SUMMARIZE`

Data Analysis

- 50+ custom DAX measures for segmentation, risk scoring, and ROI
- Statistical aggregations, trend analysis, probability scoring
- Modeling: customer lifetime value, churn probability, recovery potential

Deliverables

- [] Power BI dashboard (`.pbix`) — 7-page interactive report
- [] Executive summary deck
- [] Recovery roadmap document
- [] Supporting datasets / data dictionary

(Add links to your actual files here once uploaded to the repo.)

Sources & References

- Business Standard, September 2025 – GST implementation coverage
 - Public market data – Google Ads CPC trends
 - Industry reports – monsoon seasonality impact on food delivery
 - Zomato & Swiggy public financial disclosures (Jun–Sep 2025)
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How to Explore

1. Clone this repository

```
git clone https://github.com/dsaikerthana/QuickBite-Express-Crisis-Impact-and-Recovery-Analysis.git
```

2. Open the `.pbix` file in **Power BI Desktop**
 3. Navigate through the 7 report pages to explore crisis metrics, segmentation, and the recovery roadmap
 4. Refer to this README for methodology and formula definitions behind each visual
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Author

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